Diabetes Remedy

The aerial parts of *Galega officinalis* (Fabaceae) contains Metformin (dimethyl biguanide). It is now reputed to be the most widely prescribed agent in the treatment of diabetes all over the world.



The attractive seeds of *Adenanthera pavonina* (Family: Caesalpiniaceae) have been used as units of weight for the measures of gold throughout India.



The seeds of *Abrus precatorius* are used in necklaces and rosaries, but are extremely poisonous and can be fatal if ingested.



2016
INTERNATIONAL
YEAR OF PULSES

The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations has been declared 2016 as the year for pulses, to make people more aware of the nutritional value of pulses.

5.13.2 Family: Apocynaceae (milk weed family) (including Asclepiadaceae)



Systematic position

APG classification		Bentham and Hooker classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade	Angiosperms	Class	Dicotyledonae
Clade	Eudicots	Sub-class	Gamopetalae
Clade	Asterides	Series	Bicarpellatae
Order	Gentianales	Order	Gentianales
Family	Apocynaceae	Family	Apocynaceae

General Characters

Distribution:

This family is represented by 345 genera, 4,675 species. Mostly tropical and subtropical whereas a few species found in temperate region.

Habit: Herb (*Catharanthus)*, shrub, (*Nerium)*, tree (*Alstonia*), woody twiner (*Allamanda*) succulent, (*Adenium*) with milky sap in laticiferous vessels.

Root: Branched tap root system

Stem: The stems are succulent in some taxa (*Stapelia, caralluma*), usually erect, branched solid, glabrous, rarely tube like and thick.

Leaves: Simple, entire, rarely stipulate (*Tabernae montana*) exstipulate, opposite decusate (*Calotropis*) or alternate (*Thevetia*) or ternate (Nerium), .

Inflorescence: A Panicle, dichasial cyme, often umbelliform in (Asclepiadoids) or raceme, or axillary cluster of two flowers each (*Catharanthus*).

Flowers: Bracteate, bracteolate, pedicellate, complete, bisexual, actinomorphic, zygomorphic in (*Ceropegia)* heterochlamydeous, pentamerous, hypogynous but rarely perigynous or epigynous



Ceropegia spp

Calyx: Sepals 5, synsepalous valvate or quincuncial (*Thevetia*), odd sepal posterior.

Corolla: Petals 5, sympetalous united into a tube, salver or funnel shaped; twisted or rarely valvate, often hairy within or contain some corona like out growths at the mouth of the corolla tube.

Androecium: Stamens 5, alternipetalous, often epipetalous, In *Asclepiadoids* the stamens are connate to the styles to form a

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